MODULE 9

Home Sweet Habitat

"What is not good for the hive is not good for the bee."

— LATIN PROVERB

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do living things in a habitat depend on each other?

MAIN STORIES

1	**The Long, Long Journey** · Sandra Markle	INFORMATIONAL
2	**Sea Otter Pups** · Ruth Owen	INFORMATIONAL
3	**At Home in the Wild** · Poetry Collection	POETRY & SONG
4	**Abuelo and the Three Bears** · Jerry Tello	FOLKTALE

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NAME _____ DATE _____

Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 9 · Home Sweet Habitat · Grade 2 · 27 Items

CCSS L.2.4 · L.2.5 · L.2.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.2.6

habitat

A **habitat** is —

- ○ **A.** a habit you do every day.
- ○ **B.** a big city street.
- ○ **C.** a place where plants and animals live and grow.
- ○ **D.** the food that an animal hunts and eats.

Q2 L.2.6

ecosystem

An **ecosystem** is —

- ○ **A.** one single animal living all by itself.
- ○ **B.** one single plant growing all by itself.
- ○ **C.** a community of living things and their surroundings that work together.
- ○ **D.** the kind of weather a place usually has.

Q3 L.2.6

species

A **species** is —

- ○ **A.** a special kind of food a polar bear eats.
- ○ **B.** a group of living things that are the same kind, like all polar bears or all pine trees.
- ○ **C.** a single animal living on its own.
- ○ **D.** a place where one kind of animal lives.

POWER WORDS · THE LONG, LONG JOURNEY

Q4 L.2.4

wobbly

The newly hatched chick stood up on **wobbly** legs. **Wobbly** means —

- ○ **A.** very strong and steady.
- ○ **B.** able to run fast and far.
- ○ **C.** warm and covered in soft feathers.
- ○ **D.** shaky and not steady.

Q5 L.2.4

trills

When a mother godwit **trills**, she —

- ○ **A.** hides quietly in the grass.
- ○ **B.** sings a quick, high, shaking sound.
- ○ **C.** squawks one loud, harsh warning.
- ○ **D.** pokes in the mud for food.

Q6 L.2.4

crouches

When the falcon appears, the chick **crouches** in the grass. To **crouch** is to —

- ○ **A.** jump as high as you can.
- ○ **B.** run away as fast as you can.
- ○ **C.** bend your body down low and close to the ground.
- ○ **D.** fly straight up into the air.

POWER WORDS · THE LONG, LONG JOURNEY (CONTINUED)

Q7 L.2.5 TRAP

coast

When a bird **coasts** on the wind, it —

- ○ **A.** move smoothly without flapping — gliding.
- ○ **B.** the edge of land next to the sea.
- ○ **C.** flap the wings hard, over and over.
- ○ **D.** dive straight down into the water.

Q8 L.2.4

prances

The young godwit **prances** on the mudflat. To **prance** is to —

- **A.** stand or sit very still.
- **B.** walk or move with high, playful steps.
- **C.** poke a long beak deep into the mud.
- **D.** lie down flat in the mud.

Q9 L.2.4

flock

"The young female rises with the **flock**." Here, **flock** means —

- **A.** a single bird flying all by itself.
- **B.** the long path that the birds follow each year.
- **C.** the warning call a parent bird makes.
- **D.** a large group of birds that fly together.

Q10 L.2.4

route

The flock follows a long flight **route** from Alaska to New Zealand. A **route** is —

- **A.** a thick plant root that grows under the ground.
- **B.** a large group of birds flying together.
- **C.** a path that you take to get from one place to another.
- **D.** a resting place to stop along the way.

Q11 L.2.5 TRAP

mingles

When a young godwit **mingles** with the flock, it —

- **A.** shouts at others until they leave.
- **B.** mangles or breaks them apart.
- **C.** hides alone where no one can see.
- **D.** moves among others and mixes in with them.

Q12 L.2.5 TRAP

surface

"She swims back up to the water's **surface**." Here, **surface** means —

- **A.** the top layer of the water.
- **B.** the deepest part of the ocean floor.
- **C.** a hard, flat top you can skate on.
- **D.** the thick fur on an animal's back.

Q13 L.2.4

wraps

"The otter **wraps** seaweed around its body." To **wrap** is to —

- **A.** tear something into many pieces.
- **B.** cover or wind something all the way around.
- **C.** let something drift freely away.
- **D.** pull something off and toss it aside.

Q14 L.2.4

attached

The tiny pup stays **attached** to her mother. To be **attached** is to —

- **A.** be very far away from each other.
- **B.** drift alone with no help.
- **C.** be joined or fastened to something else.
- **D.** float loose and on its own.

Q15 L.2.5 TRAP

crack

"The otter uses a small rock to **crack** open shellfish." Here, **crack** means —

- **A.** a funny joke that makes people laugh.
- **B.** a thin line in a wall or a window.
- **C.** the loud sound a whip makes.
- **D.** hit something hard so it breaks open.

Q16 L.2.4

sheltered

"The polar bear mama goes to find a **sheltered** winter place." A **sheltered** place is —

- **A.** a place full of wind, snow, and rain.
- **B.** a place that protects you from cold, wind, or danger.
- **C.** a bare, open hilltop high up.
- **D.** a place out in the open Arctic sun.

Q17 L.2.4

weary

"The cubs are **weary**, so they ride their mama home." **Weary** means —

- **A.** full of energy and ready to play.
- **B.** hungry for warm food.
- **C.** very tired after a long day.
- **D.** scared of the cold and the dark.

Q18 L.2.5 TRAP

hide

"I'm a moose with a tough, shaggy **hide**." In this poem, **hide** means —

- **A.** the skin or thick coat of an animal.
- **B.** to go where no one can see you.
- **C.** a place to play hide-and-seek.
- **D.** to cover something with a blanket.

Q19 L.2.5 TRAP

wit

"The night contains his **wit**" — the poet means the cricket's **wit** is —

- **A.** the chirping sound of his song.
- **B.** the dark, quiet night around him.
- **C.** the stars up in the night sky.
- **D.** the cleverness or smart thinking in his song.

Q20 L.2.4

arrive

Emilio waits for his cousins to **arrive**. To **arrive** is to —

- **A.** leave a place and walk away.
- **B.** reach a place at the end of a trip.
- **C.** wait a long time for someone to come.
- **D.** pack up and start a trip.

Q21 L.2.4

grumpy

"Papa Bear woke up as **grumpy** as ever." **Grumpy** means —

- **A.** very happy and smiling.
- **B.** sleepy and slow to wake up.
- **C.** in a bad mood and easy to anger.
- **D.** very kind and gentle to everyone.

Q22 L.2.4

joking

"Abuelo, you're **joking**!" laughed Emilio. To be **joking** is to —

- **A.** tell only true, real stories.
- **B.** get angry about something small.
- **C.** speak in a very serious way.
- **D.** say something funny that you do not really mean.

Q23 L.2.5 TRAP

tucked

"Papa Bear sat down and **tucked** a napkin under his chin." Here, **tucked** means —

- **A.** hit something hard so it broke.
- **B.** pushed gently into place to hold it there.
- **C.** picked up and threw it across the room.
- **D.** pulled it loose and let it drop.

Q24 L.2.4

stubborn

"**Stubborn** Papa Bear didn't listen to Mama Bear's warning." **Stubborn** means —

- **A.** easy to please and quick to agree.
- **B.** happy to listen to other people's advice.
- **C.** refusing to change your mind, even when others ask.
- **D.** quick to change his mind and his plans.

Q25 L.2.4

growled

"Ay!" he **growled**, jumping out of his chair. To **growl** is to —

- **A.** whisper softly so no one hears.
- **B.** sing a sweet song to a baby.
- **C.** ask politely with a smile.
- **D.** make a low, angry sound deep in the throat.

Q26 L.2.4

shrugged

"Goldilocks?" Abuelo **shrugged**. "In my story it was Trencitas with her long black braids who came to visit." To **shrug** is to —

- **A.** lift your shoulders up to show "I don't know" or "I don't mind."
- **B.** nod your head up and down.
- **C.** hug someone tightly with both arms.
- **D.** point at something with one finger.

Q27 L.2.5 TRAP

offered

"There'll be beans at my house," **offered** Trencitas. To **offer** something is to —

- **A.** give or hold something out to someone, hoping they will take it.
- **B.** take something away without asking.
- **C.** refuse to share with anyone at all.
- **D.** shout an order that must be obeyed.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 9 · Home Sweet Habitat · Grade 2 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.2.1 – RL.2.7 / RI.2.1 – RI.2.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Story 1 · The Long, Long Journey

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · SANDRA MARKLE · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.2.1

Where does the little female godwit chick hatch at the start of the story?

- ○ **A.** In the tundra of Alaska.
- ○ **B.** In a forest in New Zealand.
- ○ **C.** Inside a city park.
- ○ **D.** On a sandy beach in the desert.

Q2 RI.2.3

How does the mother godwit help her chick when an Arctic fox is near?

- ○ **A.** She runs away and leaves the chick alone.
- ○ **B.** She fights the fox with her wings.
- ○ **C.** She sings a happy song.
- ○ **D.** She trills a warning so the chick can crouch low and hide.

Q3 RI.2.3

According to the text, what happens to the chick's legs as she grows?

- ○ **A.** Her legs stay wobbly forever.
- ○ **B.** Wobbly legs become strong enough to walk, run, and prance.
- ○ **C.** Her legs fall off so wings can grow.
- ○ **D.** She grows four legs instead of two.

Q4 RI.2.3

Why does the godwit chick CROUCH when a peregrine falcon comes?

- **A.** Because she wants to play hide-and-seek.
- **B.** Because she is too cold to fly.
- **C.** So the falcon will not spot her — staying low and still keeps her safe.
- **D.** Because the fox told her to.

Q5 RI.2.3

Where do the godwits FLY at the end of their long journey?

- **A.** All the way to the coast of New Zealand.
- **B.** Only as far as the next nest.
- **C.** Back to the tundra in winter.
- **D.** Up to the top of a mountain in Alaska.

Q6 RI.2.5

"The Long, Long Journey" is INFORMATIONAL text. What makes it informational?

- **A.** It follows one chick like a story character, so it must be a made-up tale.
- **B.** It gives real facts about how a real bird species grows, hides, and migrates.
- **C.** It uses describing words like "wobbly" and "trills," so it must be a poem.
- **D.** It tells about a long trip, so it must be a personal diary.

Q7 RI.2.6

Why does the author follow ONE chick from hatching to New Zealand?

- **A.** To show that this one chick is special and braver than the rest of the flock.
- **B.** To prove that the flock would be safer without her.
- **C.** To compare her hatching place in Alaska with the fox's home.
- **D.** So the reader sees how each step depends on her habitat.

Q8 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Long, Long Journey"?

- **A.** A brave chick crosses the world all alone, without help from anyone else.
- **B.** The Arctic fox and the peregrine falcon are the real heroes of the journey.
- **C.** A godwit grows up and depends on her flock and habitat to make the long journey.
- **D.** Godwits stay in Alaska and never fly all the way to New Zealand.

Story 2 · Sea Otter Pups

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · RUTH OWEN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.2.1

Where do sea otter pups LIVE, according to the text?

- ○ **A.** In a hot desert.
- ○ **B.** In the cool ocean, near the kelp.
- ○ **C.** Inside a deep cave on land.
- ○ **D.** Up in the trees of a forest.

Q10 RI.2.3

How does a mother sea otter CARRY her pup?

- ○ **A.** On her tummy while she floats on her back.
- ○ **B.** In a small basket on her head.
- ○ **C.** Pulled behind on a string.
- ○ **D.** She leaves the pup on the beach.

Q11 RI.2.3

How does the otter open a hard shellfish?

- ○ **A.** It bites it open with sharp teeth.
- ○ **B.** It puts the shellfish into a fire.
- ○ **C.** It smashes the shellfish open with a small rock.
- ○ **D.** It waits for the shell to open by itself.

Q12 RI.2.3

Why do sea otters sleep wrapped in KELP?

- ○ **A.** Because kelp is warm like a blanket.
- ○ **B.** Because kelp tastes sweet.
- ○ **C.** Because kelp glows in the dark.
- ○ **D.** So they will not drift away with the waves while they sleep.

Q13 RI.2.3

According to the text, who TEACHES a sea otter pup to swim and find food?

- **A.** The mother sea otter teaches her pup.
- **B.** A passing whale teaches the pup.
- **C.** The pup learns from books.
- **D.** Nobody — the pup is born knowing everything.

Q14 RI.2.8

The text says the mother otter brings a rock up to the surface with her. What REASON does the author give for this?

- **A.** So the pup will have a small rock to play with in the water.
- **B.** So she can smash a clam against the rock to break the shell open.
- **C.** So she can build a nest out of rocks near the kelp.
- **D.** So she can keep the rock warm on her belly while she sleeps.

Q15 RI.2.6

Why does Ruth Owen show so many CLOSE-UP photos of otter pups?

- **A.** So readers will think otters are made up.
- **B.** Because she could not find any words.
- **C.** So readers can SEE exactly how the mother and pup depend on each other in their ocean habitat.
- **D.** To sell otter toys.

Q16 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Sea Otter Pups"?

- **A.** A pup learns to swim and crack shellfish all by itself, without its mother.
- **B.** The kelp and the rocks are the only things a pup truly needs in the ocean.
- **C.** The mother sea otter teaches the pup, but the ocean habitat does not matter.
- **D.** A pup depends on its mother AND its ocean habitat to learn how to live.

Story 3 · At Home in the Wild

POETRY AND SONG COLLECTION · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.2.1

In the polar bear poem, where do the cubs ROMP with their mama?

- **A.** In the cold white snow.
- **B.** Up in the green tree branches.
- **C.** Inside a sandy desert.
- **D.** At the bottom of the ocean.

Q18 RL.2.4

In "Big Brown Moose" by Joyce Sidman, the moose is "RAVENOUS after the long winter." This MOST helps the reader feel —

- **A.** how soft and sleepy the moose is.
- **B.** how hungry the moose is after months without enough food.
- **C.** how the moose loves to dance.
- **D.** how the moose enjoys swimming.

Q19 RL.2.3

In "Over in the Meadow," who lives in the meadow habitat together?

- **A.** Just the frogs and the fish in the meadow pond.
- **B.** Just the birds in the trees and the bees in the flowers.
- **C.** Frogs, fish, birds, wolves, and bees — all together.
- **D.** Just one mother duck with her ducklings, and no one else.

Q20 RL.2.5

"At Home in the Wild" is a POETRY collection. What makes it poetry?

- **A.** It is one long science chapter.
- **B.** It is a list of phone numbers.
- **C.** It is a set of instructions to build a house.
- **D.** It uses short lines, rhythm, and sound — and many short poems share one big topic (animals at home).

Q21 RL.2.4

In "The Cricket" by Alberto Blanco, the cricket SINGS at night. The poet MOST likely wants the reader to feel —

- ○ **A.** that even a tiny creature has a voice in its habitat.
- ○ **B.** that the night is scary.
- ○ **C.** that crickets are dangerous.
- ○ **D.** that all bugs are loud.

Q22 RL.2.6

In "What Rhino Knows," the poem is told from the RHINO'S point of view. What does this help the reader do?

- ○ **A.** Forget that rhinos exist.
- ○ **B.** See the habitat through the rhino's eyes — what it KNOWS about its home.
- ○ **C.** Learn how to draw a rhino.
- ○ **D.** Count the rhino's feet.

Q23 RL.2.9

How is "At Home in the Wild" DIFFERENT from "Sea Otter Pups"?

- ○ **A.** Both are the same long science text.
- ○ **B.** "At Home in the Wild" has no animals at all.
- ○ **C.** "At Home in the Wild" uses short poems with rhythm and feeling, while "Sea Otter Pups" uses real facts and photos.
- ○ **D.** "Sea Otter Pups" is a fairy tale.

Q24 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "At Home in the Wild"?

- ○ **A.** Only the polar bear cub truly belongs in its habitat; the cricket and rhino do not.
- ○ **B.** Every animal would rather leave its wild home and live somewhere new.
- ○ **C.** The poems show animals living alone, with no parents and no other creatures nearby.
- ○ **D.** Every animal — cub to cricket to rhino — has a home in the wild where it belongs.

Story 4 · Abuelo and the Three Bears

FOLKTALE · JERRY TELLO · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.2.1

Why does Emilio go to ABUELO at the start of the story?

- **A.** He is waiting for his cousins, and Abuelo offers to tell him a story.
- **B.** He is lost in a forest.
- **C.** He is looking for three bears.
- **D.** He is hungry and wants a sandwich.

Q26 RL.2.3

Why is Papa Bear called STUBBORN in Abuelo's story?

- **A.** Because he growls at Mama Bear and walks out of the kitchen.
- **B.** Because he will not change his mind, even when the frijoles are too hot.
- **C.** Because he shrugs his shoulders and lets Mama Bear decide everything.
- **D.** Because he is grumpy that Osito's chair is broken.

Q27 RL.2.3

Who is TRENCITAS in this story?

- **A.** A bear who lives with the other three bears.
- **B.** Emilio's older cousin.
- **C.** A girl whose name means "Little Braids" in Spanish — she takes the place of Goldilocks in this version.
- **D.** The name of Abuelo's dog.

Q28 RL.2.3

What happens AFTER Trencitas breaks Osito's chair?

- **A.** She runs out of the house at once.
- **B.** She fixes the chair perfectly.
- **C.** She turns into a bear.
- **D.** She falls asleep on Osito's small bed.

Q29 RL.2.3

When the three bears come home and find Trencitas, how does the story END?

- **A.** The bears and Trencitas all go to her house and share a meal of tortillas and salsa.
- **B.** The bears chase Trencitas away forever.
- **C.** Trencitas eats all the bears' food.
- **D.** Osito moves out of the house.

Q30 RL.2.6

Why does Jerry Tello use SPANISH words like "Abuelo," "Osito," and "frijoles"?

- **A.** To make the story shorter.
- **B.** To show that this version of the folktale belongs to a Latino family — the language is part of their home.
- **C.** Because he forgot the English words.
- **D.** Because Spanish words sound funny.

Q31 RL.2.9

How is "Abuelo and the Three Bears" DIFFERENT from a classic "Goldilocks" you may know?

- **A.** The girl's name is Goldilocks, but she eats frijoles instead of porridge.
- **B.** Papa Bear, Mama Bear, and Osito are the same, but the girl runs away at the end as usual.
- **C.** The girl is Trencitas, the food is frijoles, and the ending is sharing tortillas.
- **D.** Abuelo himself takes the place of Goldilocks and tries the three bowls.

Q32 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Abuelo and the Three Bears"?

- **A.** A folktale is only "real" when it is told the same way every time, with the same words.
- **B.** The Spanish words in the story are fun, but they do not change the meaning of the tale.
- **C.** Abuelo tells the story so Emilio will stop waiting for his cousins and play alone.
- **D.** An old folktale, retold in a Latino home and ending in a shared meal, shows a home welcomes everyone.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 9 · Home Sweet Habitat · Grade 2

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply about how living things in a habitat depend on each other. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change DOK 3

In **"The Long, Long Journey,"** a tiny godwit chick CHANGES from hatching to migrating. Show how she changes from the tundra to New Zealand — and how her habitat helps her.

GODWIT CHICK · TUNDRA TO NEW ZEALAND

JUST HATCHED · TUNDRA	→	READY TO FLY · MIGRATING

What does the habitat (grass, mudflat, sky, flock) give her at each step?

Q2 Responsibility DOK 2

In **"Sea Otter Pups,"** the mother otter has THREE big jobs. Show what she does for her pup, step by step.

MOTHER OTTER · 3 JOBS

JOB 1 · CARRY & FLOAT	JOB 2 · FEED & SMASH	JOB 3 · WRAP IN KELP

Which job would the pup MOST struggle to do alone? Why?

Q3 Connection DOK 3

In **"At Home in the Wild,"** many animals share one habitat (Over in the Meadow). Map who lives there — and how they DEPEND on each other.

MEADOW WEB · WHO DEPENDS ON WHOM

Meadow Habitat

FROG · WHAT IT NEEDS

BEE · WHAT IT NEEDS

BIRD · WHAT IT NEEDS

WOLF · WHAT IT NEEDS

If the BEES disappeared, what would change for the others? Why?

Q4 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Abuelo and the Three Bears,"** the same folktale is told from a NEW home — a Latino family. Trace THREE choices Jerry Tello made that show this is a different home.

THREE CHOICES · A NEW HOME FOR AN OLD STORY

NAME · TRENCITAS

why this name, not Goldilocks?

FOOD · FRIJOLES

why beans, not porridge?

ENDING · SHARING

why share tortillas at the end?

Which choice changes the story the MOST? Why does it matter?

Q5 Reflection DOK 4

Essential Question: How do living things in a habitat depend on each other? Use ideas from TWO of the texts in this module to answer.

TWO-TEXT SYNTHESIS

TEXT 1 · TITLE & AUTHOR

How does ONE living thing in this text depend on another to survive?

TEXT 2 · TITLE & AUTHOR

How does ONE living thing in this text depend on another to survive?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 9 · Home Sweet Habitat · Grade 2

MAP RIT 180 → 200 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Pond at the Park

Soo-ah walked to the park with her grandpa. They went straight to the small pond. The pond was full of life. Tiny green plants floated on top of the water. Below, little fish flicked through the weeds. A small frog sat on a flat stone. Bees buzzed near pink flowers at the edge of the pond. Soo-ah saw a duck land on the water. The duck dipped her head down and grabbed a weed. "Why are there so many animals here?" Soo-ah asked. Grandpa smiled. "This pond is a habitat. The plants feed the fish. The fish feed the frog. The flowers feed the bees. The duck eats the weeds. They all depend on this water and this place. Take one thing away, and the pond changes." Soo-ah watched a long time. The pond looked small, but it was a whole world.

148 WORDS · LEXILE 240–290L · RIT 180–189

Q1 RIT 180 · Lexile 240L · Key Detail

Where did Soo-ah go with her grandpa?

- ○ **A.** To a small pond in the park.
- ○ **B.** To the beach by the ocean.
- ○ **C.** To the top of a tall mountain.
- ○ **D.** To a busy city street.

Q2 RIT 184 · Lexile 250L · Cause & Effect

Why does Grandpa say the pond is "a whole world"?

- ○ **A.** Because the pond is very deep.
- ○ **B.** Because the water is colored blue.
- ○ **C.** Because many living things — plants, fish, frog, bees, duck — all live there and depend on each other.
- ○ **D.** Because the pond has a big sign next to it.

Q3 RIT 186 · Lexile 260L · Inference

What would MOST likely happen if all the plants in the pond disappeared?

- ○ **A.** The fish, duck, and frog would lose their food and shelter — the whole pond would change.
- ○ **B.** The pond would become deeper.
- ○ **C.** The bees would learn to swim.
- ○ **D.** Soo-ah would never go to the park again.

Q4 RIT 188 · Lexile 270L · Vocabulary

In the passage, Grandpa says, "This pond is a HABITAT." Here, "habitat" most likely means —

- ○ **A.** a place where many plants and animals live and depend on each other.
- ○ **B.** a kind of jacket you wear.
- ○ **C.** a single big rock.
- ○ **D.** a small toy boat.

Q5 RIT 189 · Lexile 290L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Pond at the Park"?

- ○ **A.** Ponds are too small to matter.
- ○ **B.** Only ducks belong near water.
- ○ **C.** Grandparents do not know about ponds.
- ○ **D.** Even a small pond is a habitat where every living thing depends on the others.

Passage 2 · The Bees and the Apple Tree

In Min-jun's backyard there was one old apple tree. Every spring, the tree filled with pink flowers. Every summer, bees came. They flew from flower to flower. Their tiny legs got dusty with yellow powder. The bees did not know it, but they were doing an important job. They were moving pollen from one flower to another. Without the bees, the flowers would not turn into apples. Min-jun's mother said, "If we lose the bees, we lose the apples too." One year, fewer bees came. Min-jun looked. He counted only three. By the end of summer, the tree had only a few small apples. The next spring, Min-jun's family planted flowers all around the yard. By summer, the bees came back. By fall, the tree was full of round red apples again. Min-jun smiled. He knew the apples and the bees were a team.

149 WORDS · LEXILE 300–350L · RIT 190–195

Q6 RIT 190 Lexile 300L Key Detail

What did Min-jun have in his backyard?

- **A.** One old apple tree.
- **B.** A pond full of fish.
- **C.** A small lemon tree.
- **D.** A field of corn.

Q7 RIT 192 Lexile 320L Cause & Effect

Why did the tree have only a FEW small apples one year?

- **A.** The tree was getting old and tired.
- **B.** Fewer bees came, so less pollen was moved from flower to flower.
- **C.** The mother forgot to water it.
- **D.** A storm broke all the branches.

Q8 RIT 193 Lexile 330L Vocabulary

In the passage, "moving pollen from one flower to another" most likely means —

- **A.** washing the flowers with water.
- **B.** cutting flowers to put in a vase.
- **C.** carrying the yellow powder so flowers can turn into fruit.
- **D.** eating the flowers.

Q9 RIT 194 Lexile 340L Inference

Why did the family plant FLOWERS all around the yard?

- **A.** Because flowers look pretty in photos.
- **B.** Because the apple tree was lonely.
- **C.** Because they wanted more shade in the yard.
- **D.** To bring the bees back — more flowers mean more food, and more bees mean more apples.

Q10 RIT 195 Lexile 350L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Bees and the Apple Tree"?

- **A.** Apples grow alone with no help.
- **B.** Bees only matter in big farms, not in a backyard.
- **C.** A tree and its bees are a team — the fruit depends on the insect, and the insect depends on the flower.
- **D.** Only farmers can grow apples.

Passage 3 · The Tide Pool

Hae-jin and her father walked down to the sea at low tide. Between the rocks, they found small pools of water. These were tide pools. In one pool, Hae-jin saw a tiny crab walking sideways. In another, a starfish stuck to a stone. Bright green seaweed waved in the water. A small fish darted past her hand. "Look closer," her father said. "Every animal here has a job." He pointed to the seaweed. "The seaweed makes food from sunlight. The little fish eats the seaweed. The crab eats bits left behind. The starfish eats the small clams that hide in the rocks." Hae-jin looked again. The tide pool was no bigger than a hat. But in that little pool, the sun fed the plants. The plants fed the fish. The fish fed the crab. The crab and clams fed the starfish. The whole habitat fit in a puddle.

150 WORDS · LEXILE 360–410L · RIT 195–199

Q11 RIT 195 Lexile 360L Key Detail

When did Hae-jin and her father visit the sea?

- ○ **A.** At sunset when the water was high.
- ○ **B.** At low tide, when small pools formed between the rocks.
- ○ **C.** During a heavy storm.
- ○ **D.** In the middle of the night.

Q12 RIT 196 Lexile 370L Cause & Effect

Why does the father say "every animal here has a JOB"?

- ○ **A.** Because each animal eats or feeds another, so the whole habitat keeps working.
- ○ **B.** Because the animals all wear name tags.
- ○ **C.** Because each animal has to clean up rocks.
- ○ **D.** Because the animals are training to be in a circus.

Q13 RIT 197 Lexile 380L Vocabulary

In the passage, "the small fish DARTED past her hand" most likely means —

- ○ **A.** The fish floated very slowly.
- ○ **B.** The fish moved past quickly in a short, sudden burst.
- ○ **C.** The fish jumped out of the water.
- ○ **D.** The fish wrote her a note.

Q14 RIT 198 | Lexile 390L | Inference

Why does the passage say the tide pool is "no bigger than a hat"?

- ○ **A.** To show that hats can hold water.
- ○ **B.** To show that even a TINY habitat can hold a whole food chain — sun, plants, fish, crab, starfish.
- ○ **C.** Because the father is wearing a hat.
- ○ **D.** To prove tide pools are useless.

Q15 RIT 199 | Lexile 410L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Tide Pool"?

- ○ **A.** Tide pools are dangerous.
- ○ **B.** Starfish are the only important animal in the sea.
- ○ **C.** Only big oceans matter.
- ○ **D.** Even a tiny habitat is a full ecosystem — the sun feeds the plants, the plants feed the fish, the fish feed the crab, and the crab and clams feed the starfish.

Passage 4 · The Coral Reef

A coral reef is one of the most colorful habitats in the ocean. The reef is built by tiny animals called corals. Each coral is smaller than a pencil eraser. Together, billions of corals build a strong stone wall over hundreds of years. The reef gives a home to many living things. Bright fish hide in cracks. Small octopuses rest in holes. Sea turtles glide above. Cleaner fish nibble bits of food off bigger fish — both animals are helped. The bigger fish gets clean; the cleaner fish gets a meal. If the water gets too warm or too dirty, the corals get sick. They turn white. When the corals die, the fish lose their home. The turtles cannot find food. The whole reef falls apart. Scientists are working to protect the reefs. They know that one reef is not just stone — it is a city of life that depends on every piece.

150 WORDS · LEXILE 440–500L · RIT 199–200

Q16 RIT 199 | Lexile 440L | Key Detail

According to the passage, who BUILDS the coral reef?

- ○ **A.** Tiny animals called corals build the reef together.
- ○ **B.** Sea turtles build the reef with their shells.
- ○ **C.** Scientists in boats build the reef.
- ○ **D.** Octopuses build the reef from sand.

Q17 RIT 200 | Lexile 460L | Cause & Effect

Why is the cleaner fish and the bigger fish a good EXAMPLE of how living things depend on each other?

- **A.** Because the two fish look the same.
- **B.** Because the bigger fish gets clean and the cleaner fish gets food — both win.
- **C.** Because the bigger fish eats the cleaner fish.
- **D.** Because they swim in opposite directions.

Q18 RIT 200 | Lexile 480L | Vocabulary

In the passage, "the reef gives a HOME to many living things." Here, "home" most likely means —

- **A.** a building with windows and doors.
- **B.** only a place to sleep.
- **C.** a HABITAT — a place to live, hide, and find food.
- **D.** a small bag for carrying things.

Q19 RIT 200 | Lexile 490L | Inference

Why MOST likely do scientists work to protect the reefs?

- **A.** Because reefs are made of gold.
- **B.** Because the corals look pretty in photos.
- **C.** Because scientists collect reefs to take home.
- **D.** Because if the corals die, every other animal that depends on the reef will lose its home and its food.

Q20 RIT 200 | Lexile 500L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Coral Reef"?

- **A.** Coral reefs are only stones.
- **B.** Only big fish matter in the ocean.
- **C.** A coral reef is a habitat where every living thing — corals, fish, octopus, turtle — depends on the others, and protecting one piece protects the whole.
- **D.** Coral reefs only live in cold water.